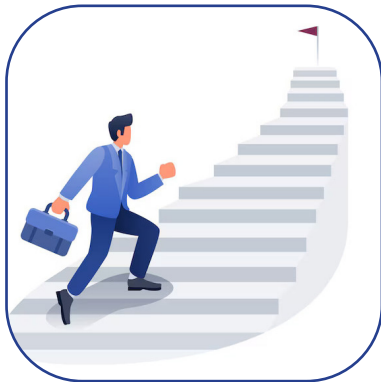


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Page 11

DESIGN CREDITS:

Rohan Pudari
Manvitha Yalamanchili
Manish
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-Sanvith Murari, Sameeha Yasmin, Bhavya Veeramreddy

You will probably find yourself asking someone for directions to the N-block seminar hall soon. Before you know it, you'll be on the other end answering the same question. Your walk from the gate to the classroom might feel full of unfamiliarity, but by this time next year, you'd stop for so many greetings, you will end up having to run to class. Although the campus feels foreign right now, over the next 4 years each corner would feel like home. Once you find your way around the campus, you'll start discovering ways within it.

Going forward, there will be late nights spent preparing for exams, only for you to realise that CBIT offers countless opportunities for growth beyond the classroom. There is a platform to nurture and showcase all your innate talents through the various college clubs. CBIT helps nurture different parts of yourself: Shruthi celebrates the artist in you, Sudhee brings out the innovator in you and Aura lets your athletic prowess steal the spotlight. Your journey will start with welcoming and supportive faculty, as well as seniors who are always there to show you the ropes. You have a massive campus that is entirely yours to write, and as every great story proves, it all begins with a blank page. The best part? You won't have to do any of it alone. You could have brushed past your to-be best friend 10 minutes ago and you may never realise. By the time you graduate, you will have enough memories to last you a lifetime and a group you can call family. The days might seem endless, but the semesters will go by in a blink. So just go where the wind takes you, but make sure you know your direction. It's a challenging journey and not giving up at the first sign of turbulence is the most important part of it all.

It will soon be apparent that college life is wonderful and loud, filled with impromptu canteen visits and battling to buy records in long queues. For now though, you don't need to have it all figured out. In fact, you aren't even supposed to. The true magic of this place is watching yourself evolve from a nervous fresher into a proud alumni, leaving a permanent mark here. Exactly a year from now, you'll be looking down at this very newsletter, possibly having written something in it, handing it off to an anxious face and smiling to yourself as you realize you're the one showing them the way home.

Dear Juniors, we welcome you all to script your own versions of Happy Days on a journey that feels like a good cup of coffee!

Welcome, Class of 2030.

TEAM TRANSCENDENT 2026-27

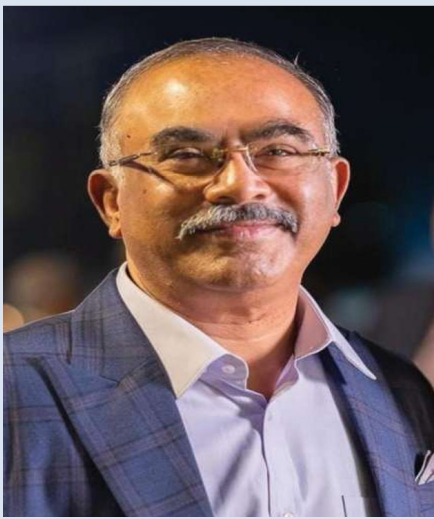


Guided by Faculty Coordinator:
Dr. Shirisha Deshpande

Not in frame: Riddhima Prasad



MESSAGE FROM THE PRESIDENT
Sri. Subash Namburu



CBIT extends a warm and heartfelt welcome to each one of you, the spirited incoming batch of 2026, as you begin your journey with us. Every year, we are energized by a new wave of bright minds, each bringing with them unique dreams, fresh perspectives, and boundless potential. Our team at CBIT looks forward to guiding and supporting you as you carve your path towards success, self-discovery, and personal growth during your time here. It is truly fulfilling to reflect on the strides we have made in our commitment to excellence in education and holistic development. At CBIT, our mission has always been to empower our students with the resources, knowledge, and skills they need to thrive in an ever-evolving world. We remain deeply committed to nurturing creativity, inspiring innovation, and fostering a learning environment where your aspirations can thrive. In this transformative age of AI-driven technologies, digital breakthroughs, and global connectivity, students like you are entering an era filled with extraordinary possibilities. With

access to vast knowledge, cutting-edge tools, and powerful platforms for collaboration, you hold in your hands the power to create meaningful and lasting change. We have unshakable confidence in the ingenuity and determination of our youth. As future engineers, innovators, and leaders, we encourage you to harness these opportunities to uplift not only your lives but also the society you are part of. At CBIT, we believe in the transformative power of technology to shape a better world, and it is now your turn to carry that mantle forward. The coming four years will be pivotal, a time to challenge yourself, build lifelong friendships, and make an indelible mark on the world around you. Education, after all, is not merely a personal investment; it is a commitment to collective progress and national growth. We are certain that you will meet this challenge with zeal and dedication. We urge each of you to push beyond your comfort zones, be open to diverse ideas, and relentlessly pursue your goals with passion. While ambition sets the direction, it is your perseverance and hard work that will define your journey. Sharpen your ability to communicate effectively, collaborate with empathy, and lead with integrity; these are the cornerstones of success in both professional and personal life. At CBIT, we are committed to helping you cultivate these essential skills and to providing you with every opportunity to grow into the best version of yourself. As you step into this new and exciting phase, we extend our sincerest good wishes. May your years at CBIT be filled with transformative learning, enduring friendships, and unforgettable memories. Make the most of every moment, seize every challenge, and earn the laurels that await your efforts.

MESSAGE FROM THE PRINCIPAL
Prof. C. V. Narsimhulu



It is with great joy and pride that I extend a warm welcome to the newly admitted students of the Academic Year 2026–27. Your choice to join CBIT speaks volumes about your ambition, your pursuit of excellence, and your determination to create a meaningful impact on the world. We are delighted to have you here and excited to accompany you on this transformative journey over the next four years. CBIT has long stood as a beacon of quality education, nurturing bright minds and producing industry-ready engineers who continue to make noteworthy contributions to society. It is a matter of great pride that this year, CBIT continues to attract the finest talent from across the state, with as many as 26 students securing a rank below 1000 in the state entrance examination choosing to begin their academic journey with us. Our consistent performance in the NIRF rankings is a reflection of our unwavering dedication to academic excellence. Yet, we do not rest on our past achievements; we constantly strive to enhance our curriculum, upgrade our infrastructure, and align our offerings with the evolving needs of industry and society. The future is in your hands, and your potential to shape it is limitless. We urge you to approach this phase of

your life with curiosity, creativity, and passion. Our investments in advanced infrastructure, experienced faculty, and strategic industry collaborations ensure that you have access to the best opportunities and resources. We also believe that holistic development is the cornerstone of true success. Beyond academics, we encourage you to immerse yourself in extracurricular activities, engage in competitions, and build lasting connections with your peers. These experiences will help shape you into not just capable professionals but also well-rounded individuals ready to take on the world. As the youth of today, you are the stewards of tomorrow. The progress of our nation and society will soon rest in your hands. As educators and mentors, we recognize the responsibility we bear in equipping you with the tools, guidance, and support you need to thrive. Our students have consistently excelled, whether through placements, academic accolades, or research achievements, a testament to the strong foundation CBIT provides. Innovation, critical thinking, and research are deeply embedded in our culture. We encourage you to bring your ideas to life, and we're here to support your journey through our incubation centres, startup initiatives, and mentorship programs. As you begin this exciting new chapter, we urge you to dream big, take initiative, and make the most of the opportunities that come your way. The road ahead will bring its share of challenges and triumphs, and I am confident that you will meet them with resilience and brilliance. Once again, welcome to CBIT. I wish you the very best as you embark on this remarkable journey. We look forward to witnessing the incredible milestones you will achieve in the years to come.

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MESSAGE FROM THE CHAIRMAN
Prof. K. Jagannadha Rao

I hope this message finds you in good health and high spirits as you begin one of the most exciting chapters of your life. It is with immense pleasure that I address you as the Chairman of the Newsletter Committee, and I extend a warm welcome to the fifteenth volume of the Transcendent’s Newsletter. In my capacity as Chairman of the Newsletter Committee, I find great pleasure in welcoming you to our scholarly community. The commencement of one’s college tenure marks a pivotal juncture in life, characterised by intellectual growth, camaraderie, and a plethora of opportunities. It is very important to be inquisitive and creative to make yourself stand out in this competitive environment. As we embark on this journey together, I encourage you to view this newsletter as more than just a source of information. It is a medium through which we can celebrate achievements, learn from one another, and collectively evolve. Through this meticulously crafted newsletter, we endeavour to serve as a conduit of vital information, ensuring that you remain well-informed about the diverse array of scholastic and extracurricular activities that grace our campus. It is our way of introducing you to the spirit of CBIT: its culture, its people, and the opportunities that lie ahead. The pages you hold are the result of passionate student voices coming together to inform, reflect, and inspire. Whether through articles, interviews, or event coverage, we strive to create something that speaks to every reader. May this newsletter be your first glimpse into the vibrant life at CBIT, and may your journey be filled with curiosity, growth, and unforgettable experiences.

MESSAGE FROM THE CONVENER
Dr. Shirisha Deshpande

I am filled with immense pride and joy as we celebrate the twenty-eighth edition of Transcendent. CBIT has always stood out as more than just an academic institution; it is a place where interdisciplinary creativity thrives. Transcendent is a perfect embodiment of this spirit, offering a platform for students to cultivate their talents in writing, speaking, and organization—skills that are essential in today’s world. It is truly a moment of pride to see how Transcendent has grown from a simple idea into a significant part of our college’s culture. Over the years, I have witnessed the creativity and commitment of the students who make this newsletter possible. Their dedication reflects the values we uphold at Transcendent: curiosity, clarity, and community. This edition captures the essence of college life through academic highlights, events, reflections, and the voices of students just like you. In today’s competitive world, curiosity and innovation are the driving forces behind success. Transcendent provides a unique platform for students to discover, refine, and express their talents in meaningful and impactful ways. As you explore this edition, I hope you find not only valuable information but also inspiration to pursue your own aspirations. I extend my heartfelt gratitude to the Editorial Board and every contributor who has dedicated their time, creativity, and energy to making this newsletter a success. Your efforts not only celebrate our community’s achievements but also inspire others to dream bigger and achieve more. Wishing everyone continued success, creativity, and good health.

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MESSAGE FROM TEAM TRANSCENDENT

- *L.Hridya, Natalie Sasha, Jai Siddarth*

Once again, it is that time of the year when students get a small glimpse into what their lives will look like for the next four years. Orientation at CBIT is more than an introduction to college; it is the first look at the experiences, opportunities, and people that will shape the years ahead. For Transcendent, orientation has always been an important occasion, giving us the opportunity to welcome a new batch and introduce them to CBIT through the stories we tell. In these pages, we try to capture the spirit of college life while bringing you stories from around the world, along with articles on technology, culture, current affairs, and much more.

This newsletter also gives us the opportunity to highlight the achievements of students and faculty across various departments. CBIT has always encouraged students to explore their interests beyond academics, be it through research, innovation, incubation, sports, cultural activities, or the numerous clubs on campus. There is always something happening here and, more importantly, always something new to be a part of. Through this edition, we hope to give you a glimpse of the many avenues available and perhaps help you discover a few that you would like to explore for yourself.

We would like to thank all the students who contributed to this edition and congratulate those whose articles were selected. The enthusiasm and effort of our contributors allow us to bring together different ideas, opinions, and perspectives with every edition. Ironically, for a club centred around writing and journalism, we still find it difficult to put into words what Transcendent has come to mean to us. It is much more than a place to write. It brings together people with different interests, skills, and personalities, united by a common love for expression and creativity. It gives us the chance to learn from one another, work as a team, and, of course, spend an unreasonable amount of time discussing words and layouts.

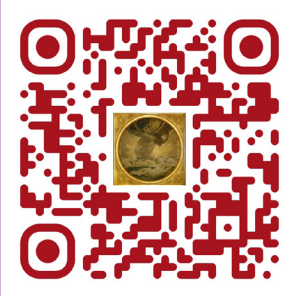
Over the years, this shared passion has resulted in 29 editions of our newsletter, over 180 weekly bulletins, numerous blog articles, and several events aimed at encouraging creativity, writing, and journalistic expression among students. Every one of these milestones represents the efforts of the many people who have been a part of Transcendent through the years. None of this would have been possible without the constant support and guidance of our faculty coordinator, Dr Shirisha Deshpande, to whom we remain immensely grateful.

As we add another edition to this journey, our Editors-in-Chief deserve special recognition for their guidance, encouragement, and constant support. The pages you hold are the collective effort of our Journalists, Sub-Editors, Editors, and Design Team, who have worked together to bring this edition to life. As always, we welcome your reviews, criticism, and suggestions, because every edition gives us another opportunity to learn, improve, and create something better than before.

To all the students beginning their journey at CBIT, orientation may be your first glimpse into college, but there is far more waiting to be discovered. The next four years will bring new people, new experiences, challenges, opportunities, and probably quite a few unexpected turns. Explore as much as you can, find what interests you, try something new, and make some good stories along the way.

After all, the rest is still unwritten.

Team Transcendent



Interested in reading more and expanding your horizons, in developing your ability to articulate, opine, comprehend and cogitate? Join us as we aim to illuminate, inform, inspire. Subscribe and never miss a post, at ParamountPress.substack.com, or scan here.

A LOOK BEHIND THE SCENES: To read excerpts from the essays on Paramount, keep reading! Paramount presents “A Clarion Call to the Healthcare Industry” — on misogyny in the medical industry, “Democracy, Debate, Dissent & Duty” — on the role of debate in democracy, and “IMPERIUM: The Dictionary of Tyrants” — on Language, Identity, and Power.



Research and Entrepreneurship Hub (R&E Hub)

- Saatvika, Shashank

Ignite your passion for innovation at the Research and Entrepreneurship (R&E) Hub of CBIT, where groundbreaking ideas come to life. Established in 2018, this multi-storied, state-of-the-art facility was created to promote research and cultivate an environment that encourages innovation and discovery. Aligned with the Government of India's 'Make in India' initiative, the R&E Hub supports advanced research, incubation, and start-up activities across all departments. Functioning through two dedicated wings—the Research and Development (R&D) Cell, which focuses on research projects and product innovation, and the Innovation and Incubation Cell (IIC), which nurtures entrepreneurial ventures—the Hub continues to identify emerging research areas and support impactful projects, playing a vital role in strengthening CBIT's research ecosystem. CBIT has established strong collaborations with several prestigious academic, research, and industry organizations, including the Department of Science and Technology (DST), ISRO, DRDO, MeitY, UGC, AICTE, ANRF, ICSSR, IIT Tirupati Navavishkar i-Hub Foundation, and the University of Pittsburgh, USA. These partnerships have contributed significantly to the institute's research ecosystem and have enabled the successful execution of numerous sponsored and consultancy projects. Since its inception, CBIT has undertaken 126 research projects, including 76 sponsored projects, 50 consultancy projects, and 106 in-house projects. Currently, the institute is executing 17 sponsored projects worth ₹777.03 lakhs, 13 consultancy projects worth ₹127.57 lakhs, and 67 in-house projects valued at ₹95.25 lakhs, while successfully completing 59 sponsored projects, 37 consultancy projects, and 39 in-house projects. These achievements reflect the institute's sustained commitment to research, consultancy, and innovation. A significant milestone for CBIT came during SEMICON India 2025, when semiconductor chips developed by CBIT faculty under the MeitY Chips to Startup (C2S) Project formed part of the Collage of Indigenous Chips unveiled by the Hon'ble Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi on 2 September 2025, highlighting the institute's contribution to India's growing semiconductor ecosystem. To further strengthen the research culture on campus, CBIT organizes Research Day annually, providing faculty, research scholars, and students with a platform to showcase their work, interact with experts from academia and industry, and exchange ideas. Since 2019, the institute has successfully conducted seven editions of Research Day, with the 8th Research Day planned for 2026. The event also recognizes excellence in research through awards for quality publications, citations, patents, sponsored research, and consultancy projects. CBIT currently houses five recognized research centers with 72 recognized Ph.D. supervisors guiding 370

registered research scholars. So far, 248 scholars have been awarded Ph.D. degrees, 20 have submitted their theses, and 94 scholars are pursuing doctoral research. The institute has produced over 5,195 research publications, receiving 39,356 citations across Scopus and Web of Science, with institutional h-indices of 65 and 48, respectively. Further adding to these accomplishments, three CBIT faculty members were featured among the World's Top 2% Scientists in the Stanford University–Elsevier rankings for 2025. The institute also continues to encourage research through internal funding and financial support. During 2025, CBIT sanctioned 35 major faculty projects worth ₹68.29 lakhs, 14 minor faculty projects worth ₹12.87 lakhs, and 25 student projects worth ₹5.84 lakhs. In addition, conference registration support amounting to ₹12.57 lakhs was provided to 135 faculty members, while 320 students received reimbursements totaling ₹29.10 lakhs. Through sustained investment in research, innovation, and entrepreneurship, the Research & Entrepreneurship Hub continues to strengthen CBIT's vision of becoming a research-driven institution while encouraging students and faculty to transform ideas into meaningful solutions.



STARS AMONG US

- Sravani, P. Teerta, Ved Karthik

Chaitanya Astra



Competition, an achievement that earned the team recognition and the opportunity to interact with Group Captain and astronaut Shubhanshu Shukla.

In the domain of autonomous systems, ASTRA designed and developed two drones, VAYU and VEDA, which won the Gold Award at the NIDAR National Drone Competition among more than 600 participating teams, securing a Top 10 national ranking for their innovative disaster management solution. The club also demonstrated excellence in satellite engineering, developing ASTRASAT, its CanSat entry for the prestigious IN-SPACE CANSAT Competition.

Building on this expertise, the team went on to secure 1st Place in the CanSat Challenge at IGNITIA Aerofest, showcasing a student-developed CanSat system with reliable telemetry and mission-execution capabilities. Further strengthening its national presence, ASTRA represented CBIT at the Andhra Pradesh SpaceTech Summit 2026, placing 4th in the Project Expo among 350+ competing teams. The club also represented the institute at the prestigious Nano Jatha Project Expo hosted by IIT Hyderabad, presenting its work in CanSat systems, avionics, and rocketry.

CBITMUN 2026: Marking its 15th Edition

For over 15 years, CBITMUN has stood as one of India's premier Model United Nations conferences, cultivating diplomacy, leadership, and critical discourse among students. Since its inception in 2011, the conference has brought together thousands of young leaders to engage with pressing global challenges, champion meaningful dialogue, and develop solutions that transcend borders. With an enduring legacy of excellence, CBITMUN has become the benchmark for collegiate Model United Nations conferences in Southern India and has earned its place among the nation's most prestigious and highly sought-after MUNs, continuing to inspire generations of delegates to lead with insight, integrity, and purpose. The 15th edition of CBITMUN 2026, hosted at Novotel, HICC saw participation from over 250 delegates, five committees, and the International Press, with a prize pool of ₹3,00,000. More than 5,000 delegates have participated over the years, reflecting the conference's legacy of debate. CBITMUN 2026 was inaugurated by Dr. C. V. Narasimhulu, Principal, CBIT in the esteemed presence of Shri Gaddam Prasad Kumar, Hon'ble Speaker of the Telangana Legislative Assembly, and Shri A. V. Ranganath, IPS, Commissioner of HYDRABAD. The conference marked the commencement of its proceedings under the mentorship of Dr. Shaguftha Parween and Dr. Rahul. Continuing a legacy of fostering informed discourse and principled leadership, CBITMUN 2026 remained committed to its core principles of exceptional debate quality and a superior delegate experience, bringing together delegates for three days of meaningful deliberation, collaboration, and diplomatic engagement.



Champions Among Us



CBIT is proud to celebrate two outstanding student-athletes who dominated the Hyderabad intercollegiate badminton circuit in 2025. Medha and Mugdha Challa, third-year students in the CSE (IoT & CSBCT) and CSE (AI & ML) departments, respectively, have brought consistent glory to the institute. Having started their sporting journey as early as sixth grade, they pursued badminton passionately before a pause during the pandemic. They returned with renewed spirit soon after joining CBIT. 2025 proved to be a memorable year as they collected an impressive amount of silverware. In the women's singles, Mugdha Challa bagged gold at the GUSTO Sports Fest, Gitam Hyderabad. Mugdha and Medha faced off in the finals at Anurag University, with Mugdha winning gold and Medha bagging the silver medal. The sisters then teamed up to win the doubles tournament at Anurag University, Vardhaman, and were runners-up at Gitam. As rewarding as laurels across the state are, wins at home are always special. Medha led her department, CSE (IoT & CSBCT), to victory at CBIT's inter-departmental sports tournaments for two straight years in 2025 and 2026.



Cracking the Code: What Got Five CBIT Students Placed

- Juluri Nithyasri, Riddhima, Hasini Anne

Nishith Vadla, CSE - AIML, Intern at Electronic Arts

Nishith Vadla’s preparation paid off with an internship offer from Electronic Arts, carrying a monthly stipend of ₹50,000. Rather than relying on a single resource, he drew on several avenues during his preparation - YouTube and Striver’s A2Z DSA Sheet proved most useful for DSA, while Angela Yu’s Udemmy course helped him build his web development foundations. His first hackathon was CBIT’s Hacktoberfest, organised by COSC, where his team built only the frontend using HTML, CSS, and Tailwind CSS, since they lacked backend experience at the time. Though they didn’t win, the experience sparked his interest in hackathons. He later built an AI Language Tutor, an end-to-end, full-stack project with scalable architecture and ML integration, which won second runner-up at the VJ Hackathon. He credits this project with strengthening his resume and helping him stand out. On placements, Nishith admitted he was nervous before his first in-person interview but grew more comfortable as the conversation with the interviewer progressed. He applied to around seven companies and received interview opportunities from Electronic Arts, Infosys, and Amazon. According to him, DSA is mandatory, but not sufficient on its own; strong projects matter just as much. He believes understanding a problem is more valuable than chasing LeetCode streaks.



M. Bharani Kumar, CSE - AIML, Intern at UBS

With a package of 13 LPA and an additional allowance on offer, M. Bharani Kumar was selected for an internship at UBS. He began preparing toward the end of his 4th semester, focusing on Data Structures and Algorithms (DSA), LeetCode, and fintech projects. UBS’s selection process involved four rounds: a written test, a case study, a technical interview, and an HR interview. During the case study, candidates had to work through a scenario involving a cybersecurity breach triggered by a fake email. In the third and fourth rounds, he was questioned on his two major projects, an agentic AI project and a financial project centred on loan services. Beyond academics, he took part in multiple hackathons, earning runner-up positions at events held at IIIT Hyderabad and VNR. Bharani said he wasn’t nervous during the interview, as he knew there would be plenty of opportunities in the years ahead. He advises students to start practising DSA and LeetCode problems early, as they are crucial to clearing the initial rounds of the interview process.



Parna Revanth Kumar, CSE - AIML, Apprentice at DBS



Revanth Kumar Parna bagged a DBS apprenticeship worth ₹36,000 a month. He began his preparation in his 5th semester, revisiting fundamental concepts such as Operating Systems and Computer Networks the day before his interview. For DSA, he prefers LeetCode, finding it easier to solve and more relevant to company assessments. He suggests that solving around 100 LeetCode problems is enough to help students grow comfortable with coding. Revanth also took part in the SIH 2025 Hackathon, where he learned the value of collaboration among peers and got to know

his teammates better. In his fifth semester, he built an AI/ML-based stock prediction system as one of his projects. He believes proctored certifications from organisations like NPTEL, Microsoft, and Salesforce add real value to a resume and help students prepare for interviews. His advice: Be mindful of your behaviour during pre-interview sessions, since even a small slip can hold you back from advancing to further rounds. Prepare DSA, projects, and technical concepts in depth, as interview questions can be unpredictable, and start early to build confidence and strengthen your fundamentals. Above all, focus on understanding concepts rather than the sheer number of questions solved.

Kushal Reddy, CSE, Intern at Barclays

Securing a Barclays internship through on-campus recruitment during his third year is one of the achievements Kushal is proudest of. The process began with an online assessment, followed by two interview rounds that probed his projects, technical approach, and scenario-based thinking, all during his first-ever in-person interview. He started on June 1, 2026, and over the next eight weeks got a close look at how fintech operates and just how far Barclays’ global footprint reaches. Working alongside experienced professionals whose guidance kept him going, he got to use enterprise-level software he’d wanted to work with for years, a full-circle experience that ran from a Friday evening deployment failure to presenting in front of the bank’s leadership. Kushal’s advice for anyone chasing a similar opportunity: explore different domains early, fail fast, and use that to find what genuinely interests you. Be an expert in one area while staying broad enough to speak to others, that combination gives you an edge once recruiters start filtering candidates. Treat DSA as a regular habit, walk into interviews confident and thorough with your resume, and try to make it a conversation rather than a Q&A. Stay curious about what the company is doing, and about where you can actually contribute.



Sarika Reddy, CSE, Intern at JP Morgan & Co.



Long before the interviews themselves, Sarika Reddy’s placement journey had already begun or so she says, looking back on her on-campus internship at JPMC. She reminisces about how her first hackathon, SIH, first sparked her interest in problem-solving. The recruitment process began around her fourth semester and unfolded in several demanding stages: resume shortlisting, a HackerRank assessment with two DSA questions, a recorded HireVue interview, and the company’s flagship “Code for Good” hackathon. The result arrived nearly a year after the process began. For her preparation, she kept her strategy simple, sticking to LeetCode and HackerRank. She believes the company values conceptual understanding over mere numbers, and advises focusing on mastering the fundamentals of strings, arrays, linked lists, and graphs rather than grinding through hundreds of questions. Her internship reinforced that belief: she wasn’t handed busy work but meaningful tasks from her manager that felt genuinely rewarding. When asked what set her apart from her peers, she doesn’t hesitate: “Technical skills will get you shortlisted, but communication skills take you the rest of the way. I’ve seen many talented people miss the opportunity simply because they couldn’t express their ideas efficiently.” Her advice is straightforward, build a strong foundation, build real projects, communicate with confidence, and trust the process.

“We never thought it was possible. Starting with a blank submission in the first round, we felt like it was just another failed opportunity yet every small lesson from our B.Tech journey, from team communication to rapid learning, pulled us through. It wasn’t magic, it was sheer perseverance! Even when we wanted to give up, we kept moving forward together, turning a disastrous start into a 3rd place win at Hackspllosion. Never lose hope, because a false start doesn’t define the finish line.”

-Team Hacksgon, Deloitte Hackspllosion 2026



DEPARTMENT HIGHLIGHTS

Computer Science and Engineering

The Department of Computer Science and Engineering, led by Dr. S. China Ramu, marked an outstanding year of academic, research, and student achievements. Faculty contributed significantly to research with 37 journal papers, 65 conference papers, and 9 published patents. Six consultancy projects from funding agencies such as TSPA, TCSiON, Vroomster Technologies Pvt., Ltd., CDAC-Future Prime, TalentioAcademy LLP, and AICTE for an overall amount of Rs 5,711,951. Consultancy collaboration with Vroomster Technologies, Talentia, and KeepInvesting of more than 3 Lakhs of rupees. The department has received a Rs. 57 lakh grant from DST-FIST to establish AR/VR, industrial automation, and robotics labs and an in-house project worth more than 2 Lakhs. This funded project highlights the department's strength in applied research and industry collaboration. Seven ongoing sponsored research projects from many funding agencies, such as ASL, DRDO, DST, AICTE, UGC, and TEQIP-II, with an overall total amount of Rs 93,35,228. Recognized as a TIER-1 Institute by Google Cloud. The department has successfully organized the International Conference series, ICICT2024 and 2025. To foster professional growth, the department organized many events, including an international online one-week workshop, summer schools, a one-day in-person staff development program, Expert-Talk, FDPs, value-added courses, expert talks, and bootcamps. A total of 159 students were placed in reputed companies such as Amazon, Salesforce, Microsoft, etc., on average. Students excelled in the Smart India Hackathon (SIH) and won the first prize worth 1,50,000/-. One-day in-person Staff Development Programme (SDP) on "Build Your Own Computer: An Innovative Methodology for Teaching Different Courses Practically in Computer Science and Allied Branches, Electronics, and Related Branches."



Computer Science & Engineering (IoT & CSBCT)



The Department of CSE (IoT & CSBCT) has 10 experienced teaching staff and 3 non-teaching staff. Faculty have served as evaluators for Hackathons and the School Innovation Marathon by the Ministry of Education and AICTE and as keynote speakers, session chairs, and resource persons at international conferences, FDPs, and expert talks. They've published 40+ research articles and 5 patents and have served as reviewers for reputed journals. The faculty has participated in the AICTE IDEA LAB Fest 2025 and earned best teacher awards. The department hosted the International Conference on AI Applications and Technological Innovations-2025 and the 1st International Conference on Power, Energy, and Secure Smart Technologies-2024; conducted 32 academic events, including short-term training programs, expert talks, bootcamps, workshops, and guest lectures; and inaugurated three IEEE Student Branch Chapters. The department received an internal seed grant of Rs. 50,000 for student projects. The department has two student clubs: the Digital Defence Club and NexIoT Club. Students secured internships at Amazon, JPMC, UBS, HackerRank, Barclays, Providence, Hexagon, DRDO, ISRO, IISc Bengaluru, IIT Hyderabad, IIIT Hyderabad, and The Linux Foundation, with stipends up to Rs. 1 lakh per month. They've won hackathons, earned certifications, and contributed to GSoC. In 2025-26, about 220 companies participated in placements, with a highest package of Rs. 30 LPA and an average of Rs. 9.18 LPA, highlighting strong industry alignment.

CSE (Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning)

The Department of CSE (Artificial Intelligence & Machine Learning), headed by Dr. Y. Ramadevi, has emerged as a centre of excellence in AI and ML education with an intake of 180 students, a total strength of 476 students, and 19 teaching and 5 non-teaching staff members. The department achieved a 100% placement record for its first graduating batch (2021-25), with students securing offers from 30+ leading companies, including Electronic Arts, JP Morgan Chase & Co., and Oracle, with salary packages ranging from ₹4.5 LPA to ₹44 LPA. More than 60% of students secured internships at reputed organizations such as F5 Networks, Oracle, Amazon, Electronic Arts, ServiceNow, Providence India, and JP Morgan Chase. Students won several national-level hackathons, including ₹2 lakh at IIT Tirupati's Clear Skies Challenge 2025, ₹1 lakh at the VNR Software Hackathon, ₹25,000 at NHETIS'25, and ₹12,000 at Datanyx-2025 FinTech Hackathon, along with multiple runner-up awards. The department also excelled in sports, winning the Shruthi 2024 Overall Men and Women Championships and other major events. 60% of faculty hold Ph.D. degrees, with several receiving Best Paper Awards. The department has secured research grants worth approximately ₹10 lakh and regularly organizes international FDPs, workshops, hackathons, and winter schools, supported by state-of-the-art laboratories and active ACM and Neural Nexus student chapters.



Information Technology



It gives me immense pleasure to welcome you to the Department of Information Technology at CBIT. Established in 2001, the department has grown into a center of academic excellence, offering B.E. Information Technology with an intake of 180 students and M.Tech. in artificial intelligence and robotics. Our department is supported by 32 highly qualified faculty members, including 20 Ph.D. holders, dedicated to quality teaching, research, and innovation. With modern laboratories and industry-focused learning, we prepare students for successful careers. Around 80% of our students secure placements in leading companies, while many others pursue higher education. Students also receive internship opportunities from the fifth semester onward. Beyond academics, we encourage participation in workshops, value-added courses, hackathons, cultural activities, and sports. Our IEEE SSIT, VMEDHA, and Digital Defence Club foster technical and leadership skills. We are also proud to host the IEEE Conference on August 13-14, 2026, further strengthening our commitment to innovation and excellence. We are proud to share that one of our students has been awarded an MSME Project Grant, recognizing their innovative project and entrepreneurial potential.

Artificial Intelligence and Data Science

Established in 2020, the Department of Artificial Intelligence & Data Science has rapidly emerged as one of CBIT's leading academic departments, expanding its B.E. intake from 60 to 120 students with 23 faculty members, including 9 Ph.D. holders and 10 pursuing doctoral research. The department strengthened its research profile with 75 journal publications, 39 conference papers, 10 patents, 1 faculty award, and externally funded research projects supported by DST and IIT Tirupati. Students earned national recognition by securing Second Prize (₹100,000) and Third Prize (₹75,000), along with internship opportunities, at the Deloitte Hacksplasion 2026 Grand Finale held at IBIS Eco Park, Bengaluru. Other achievements include 25+ student research publications, 70+ NPTEL certifications, and outstanding GATE 2026 ranks of AIR 72, AIR 338, and AIR 734. The department achieved a 70% placement record, with the highest package of 26 LPA across 35+ recruiting companies, while several graduates secured admissions to reputed international universities. Supported by fully air-conditioned laboratories, 147 high-end computers, 1 Gbps internet connectivity, smart classrooms, and advanced software, the department continues to provide an excellent environment for quality education, research, innovation, and skill development.



Civil Engineering



The Department of Civil Engineering has been serving society since the inception of the Institute through quality teaching, supported by highly qualified faculty, skilled technical staff, and state-of-the-art infrastructure. During the academic year 2025-26, the department organized the 6th Asian Conference on Ecstasy in Concrete (ACECON 2025) and conducted national-level workshops, expert talks, guest lectures, industrial and site visits, technical quizzes, model exhibitions, student technical festivals, innovation, environmental awareness, and community engagement programmes. The department is executing an Industry-Academia collaborative project worth ₹2.00 lakhs with Apaar Infratech Pvt. Ltd., 7 in-house research projects totaling ₹10.50 lakhs, and a consultancy project for Telangana Foods worth ₹33.37 lakhs, while generating ₹10.50 lakhs through consultancy services. 2 faculty members completed an international collaborative research project with Imam University, Saudi Arabia. The department published 42 research contributions, 1 patent, and submitted proposals to ANRF and the Jal Shakti Hackathon 2025. 1 faculty member received ANRF International Travel Support, and 2 faculty members joined NIT Warangal for part-time Ph.D. programmes. Students achieved 30 placements and 15 admissions to IITs, NITs, and reputed international universities.



Mechanical Engineering

The department demonstrated excellence in academics, research, and innovation by organizing its 3rd International Conference, 2 FDPs on Product Design, 1 FDP on “Empowering Educators with Emerging Technologies: PCB Machining, Industrial Drones, Laser Cutting, 3D Printing & Humanoid Robotics” under the AICTE IDEA Lab, and 1 NITTTR STTP. It conducted 3 upskilling courses on MATLAB, CFD, and manufacturing methods with ASL DRDO, along with 2 workshops on automation and drones. The department secured a ₹24 lakh DST-RPS sponsored project, published 28 research papers, generated ₹6.5 lakhs through consultancy, and achieved 11 published and 3 granted patents. Faculty organized and participated in 31 FDPs, workshops, and seminars, served as resource persons, delivered expert lectures, and conducted 6 outreach sessions for school students under the AICTE IDEA Lab. Students excelled with V. Chandana, Vishweshwar Goud, V. Rithwik, and Md Abdul Faiz winning first prize in MECHOVATE 2025, V. V. Harsha securing AIR 244 in GATE, Team R&I finishing runner-up at HAVA-NA26, Team ASTRA winning gold at NIDAR 2025–26, and Praheti Racing SAE-CBIT organizing the Oracle Red Bull Racing Formula 1 Car Show-2026. Students secured placements in Collins Aerospace, nDMtrix, FMC, Dell, Infosys, and Hyundai.



Electrical and Electronics Engineering



The Department of Electrical and Electronics Engineering has achieved academic excellence through strong mentorship, research, and outstanding student performance. The department received NBA Tier I accreditation for 6 years for its undergraduate programme and 3 years for its postgraduate programme. It has 4 professors, 1 adjunct professor, 4 associate professors, 15 assistant professors, and 3 postdoctoral researchers, with the majority of faculty holding Ph.D. degrees from IITs, NITs, and other reputed universities. 9 faculty members are supervising 48+ Ph.D. scholars and have awarded 28 doctoral degrees. The department is executing 2 internationally sponsored research projects and 1 consultancy project. It has secured 13 granted patents, published 31 patent applications, obtained 2 copyrights, and made significant contributions to high-impact journals, conference proceedings, and book chapters. 2 faculty members were recognized among Stanford University's World's Top 2% Scientists (2025). Students excelled in placements, competitive examinations, and higher studies, with K. V. Bharadwaj Karthik securing AIR 871 in GATE-2026 (Electrical Engineering) and AIR 197 in GATE-2026 (Instrumentation Engineering), alumnus Poorna Chander securing AIR 581 in GATE-2026 (Electrical Engineering), R. Trivardhan, Bhavya Labh, and Ch. Sathwika Reddy being recognized as NPTEL Discipline Stars and Motivated Learners, and Ms. B. Avanthi being crowned Miss Karnataka 2026.

Electronics and Communication Engineering

The Department of Electronics and Communication Engineering (ECE), CBIT, continued its pursuit of excellence during the academic year 2025–26 through academic innovation, research, industry collaboration, and student development. The department organized 8 Faculty Development Programmes (FDPs), 9 Webinars, 6 Workshops, 3 Seminars, 3 Guest Lectures, 23 Technical Events, 1 Regional/National Conference, and 1 International Conference. Faculty served as 22 Resource Persons, recorded 112 participations in professional development programmes, developed 3 SWAYAM MOOCs/E-content courses, and earned 47 NPTEL certifications. Research achievements included 10 International Journal publications, 62 International Conference papers, 4 books, 4 book chapters, 10 patents (granted/published/filed), 9 sponsored research projects worth ₹2.22 Crores, 1 consultancy project valued at ₹27 Lakhs, and institutional seed funding of ₹69,210. The department has 35 doctorates, 17 recognized Ph.D. supervisors, and 5 faculty awarded Ph.D. degrees during the year. Faculty mentored 11 student projects and facilitated 42 internships, industrial training programmes, and industry collaborations. Students achieved 38 National Conference publications, 24 qualifications in GATE, IELTS, and Engineering Services, 8 admissions to IITs and NITs, 53 co-curricular awards, 1 extra-curricular achievement, and 1 student entrepreneurship initiative. Graduates were placed in Infosys, Accenture, Cognizant ACE, MosChip, LTIMindtree, MSquare Technologies, and other reputed organizations. The M.E. (Embedded Systems and VLSI Design) programme received NBA accreditation for 3 years, resulting in NBA accreditation for all department programmes. The department also recognized the superannuation of Sri V. Siva Ramaiah, Lab Assistant, on 30th May 2026, after 33 years of dedicated service.



Department of Biotechnology



The Department of Biotechnology had a remarkable academic year 2025–26, excelling in academics, research, innovation, and student development. The UG programme earned NBA accreditation (2026–2028). Faculty published 9 journal articles, 13 book chapters, and 3 edited books, filed 4 patents, and participated in 25 conferences and training programmes, presenting 22 posters and products. Research garnered nearly 2,000 CrossRef citations, 2,408 Scopus citations, and a combined h-index of 27. The department secured an AICTE Research Promotion Scheme grant of ₹29.26 lakh and received multiple honours at the 7th Research Day, including the 2nd Best Product Award, Best Poster Award, and recognition for the highest Q1 journal citations. The department also organized an expert talk on “Innovative Eco-friendly Farming for a Sustainable Future” by Padma Shri Sri Chintala Venkat Reddy Garu on in association with BBCC. Students recorded 12 GATE 2026 qualifications, top ranks in GATE and TG PGECET, selection for the NPTEL Summer Internship at IIT (BHU), prizes at the Bio-Innovate Hackathon, TechnoSmania 2k26, BioQuest 2026, and World Quantum Day 2026, and gold medals in athletics and international martial arts. The department strengthened industry collaboration through MoUs with Tripura Industries and Amplikon Biosystem, while students secured internships at Roche, ICRISAT, ICMR-NIN, and Aragen Life Sciences. Graduates were placed at Indian Immunologicals Ltd. and Biological E. Ltd., with others pursuing higher studies at IIT Hyderabad and IIT Guwahati.

Chemical Engineering

The Department of Chemical Engineering has been actively engaged in academic, research, industry, and outreach activities from January 1, 2026, to the present. The department successfully organized a multidisciplinary Research Day, attracting participants from across India and fostering interdisciplinary collaboration. It also hosted CHEMSPARK-2026, a flagship student symposium centered on the theme “Pure Innovation and Zero Waste,” featuring technical paper presentations, project exhibitions, and IChE student competitions. Distinguished alumni delivered expert lectures on entrepreneurship, start-up success, and emerging research opportunities, inspiring students toward innovation and higher studies. Industrial visits to the International Advanced Research Centre for Powder Metallurgy and New Materials (ARCI), CSIR-Indian Institute of Chemical Technology (CSIR-IICT), and IIT Hyderabad provided valuable exposure to advanced research and industrial practices. The department further conducted a Winter Upskilling Certificate Course on “Gen AI for Chemical Engineers,” a workshop on “AI for Core Engineering & Industry Applications,” and successfully organized a One Week National Faculty Development Program (FDP) on “Smart and Sustainable Engineering Practices Using Artificial Intelligence for SDG Attainment,” which brought together eminent academicians, researchers, and industry experts to explore AI-driven sustainable engineering solutions aligned with the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs). A two-year training program for MSN Laboratories employees is also underway. The department signed a major consultancy MoU with MSN Laboratories, is currently executing 22 institute-funded research projects, and has achieved excellent placements, with leading recruiters such as Reliance Industries, MSN Laboratories, and Aurobindo Pharma selecting students during the current academic year.





Master Of Computer Application

The Department of Master of Computer Applications (MCA) is a vibrant centre of learning, innovation, and professional excellence, committed to preparing students for the rapidly evolving digital landscape. With a team of experienced and research-oriented faculty, well-equipped state-of-the-art computing laboratories, and a research-driven academic environment, the department provides students with a strong foundation in computing along with the skills required to excel in industry and academia. Faculty actively contribute to research through quality publications, participation in national and international conferences, and the organization of workshops, Faculty Development Programmes (FDPs), and technical events that promote continuous learning and innovation. The department emphasizes industry engagement by facilitating internships, live projects, and professional skill-development programmes, enabling students to gain practical exposure and remain industry-ready. As a result, graduates secure placements in leading multinational companies and pursue higher education at reputed universities across the world. MCA alumni have established successful careers as software engineers, data engineers, infrastructure specialists, technology consultants, and professionals in government organizations, demonstrating the department's commitment to academic excellence and career readiness. Guided by its vision of developing skilled, ethical, and socially responsible professionals, the Department of MCA continues to foster innovation, lifelong learning, leadership, and technical excellence, empowering students to make meaningful contributions to the ever-evolving world of technology.



School Of Management Studies



The School of Management Studies (SMS), is one of the leading management institutions in Telangana, offering an NBA-accredited MBA programme with an approved intake of 120 students under the Outcome Based Education framework. The department has 17 full-time faculty members and 1 Adjunct Faculty, with 17 faculty members holding Ph.D. degrees, actively contributing to research in Marketing, Human Resource Management, Finance, Business Analytics, Women Studies, Education, and interdisciplinary management. The R-26 curriculum aligns with industry requirements through case studies, live projects, mandatory internships, industry visits, guest lectures, business simulations, ICT-enabled teaching, and specializations in Marketing, Human Resources, Finance, and Business Analytics. Strong industry collaborations through MoUs

facilitate internships, consultancy, and placements in organizations such as Deloitte, Alliant Group, Asian Paints, ITC, and Franklin Templeton. Faculty have secured externally funded research projects worth ₹23 lakh and ₹15 lakh, besides internal seed grants, and the department has signed a MoU with the International University of Tourism and Entrepreneurship, Republic of Tajikistan. Supported by NAAC A++ accreditation, modern infrastructure, digital learning resources, and an active alumni network, the School continues to nurture ethical, innovative, and globally competent management professionals committed to sustainable organizational and societal impact.

Department of English

The Department of English plays a crucial role in enhancing students' communication skills, both written and Verbal. It offers courses that focus on language proficiency, technical writing, and professional communication, preparing students to effectively present ideas in a globalized, technology-driven world. Through various workshops, seminars, and activities, the department fosters critical thinking, creative expression, and interpersonal skills, ensuring that engineering students are well-equipped to succeed in their careers and beyond. The Department has 10 well qualified, experienced faculty consisting of 8 Doctorates, with the others pursuing their Ph.Ds. The faculty have published 25 research papers in reputed journals, and published 13 patents. The Department has 7 labs altogether, the Interactive Communication Skills Lab(ICS), Computer Assisted Language Learning lab(CALL) and Employability Skills Labs. Faculty members take on the role of Convenors for a diverse range of college clubs, including Communicando, the Literary Club, Transcendent, CBIT MUN, the club Chaya, play a pivotal role in shaping students' growth. These clubs are designed to nurture students into confident, skilled individuals, offering them ample opportunities for creative exploration. Students engage in debates, discussions, writing, and event management, all of which help them develop leadership abilities and prepare them for the future.



Department of Chemistry



The Department of Chemistry continues to excel in research and innovation. During the academic year 2025–2026, the department published 30 research papers in reputed Scopus and Web of Science-indexed journals and secured 10 patents, showcasing its focus on impactful research. Our faculty are currently handling total research grants worth ₹30,00,000/- from government agencies such as UGC-DAE CSR and in-house projects. These initiatives aim to establish advanced facilities in nanomaterials and catalysis, strengthening our research infrastructure. With 11 Ph.D.-qualified faculty members, the department fosters a rigorous academic environment, supported by well-equipped laboratories and state-of-the-art instrumentation. Alongside research, we actively engage students through seminars, guest lectures, and workshops, ensuring holistic learning. Committed to advancing chemical sciences, the Department of Chemistry strives to blend quality education with cutting-edge research to make meaningful contributions to science and society.

Department of Mathematics

Mathematics is the language of engineering. It provides the analytical thinking, logical reasoning, and problem-solving skills that are essential for engineers to design, analyse, and innovate in diverse technological domains. The Department of Mathematics offers 23 courses for both Undergraduate (UG) and Postgraduate (PG) programmes, catering to the mathematical requirements of various engineering and technology disciplines. The department has a team of 17 highly qualified faculty members, including 15 doctorates and 2 faculty members pursuing Ph.D. degrees. The faculty possess expertise in diverse areas of Pure and Applied Mathematics and are actively engaged in teaching, research, and academic development. During the academic year, the department actively promoted academic excellence through several knowledge enrichment initiatives, organizing 2 Guest Lectures/ Expert Talks and 1 Workshop for students and faculty. To nurture mathematical aptitude and encourage innovation among students, the department has established the Ramanujan Maths Club, which organizes various mathematics-related activities, competitions, quizzes, and interactive sessions to inspire students.



Department of Physics



The Department of Physics continues to uphold academic excellence through innovative teaching, outcome-based learning, and impactful research while remaining aligned with AICTE curriculum frameworks and accreditation standards. The department actively promotes scientific temper by organizing SIP and National Science Day celebrations, fostering curiosity and engagement among students. Faculty members actively participate in national and international conferences, contributing to the department's academic visibility and professional growth. The department has published 30 research papers in reputed journals with a good impact factor and is currently executing six externally funded research projects besides four internal seed-funded projects, significantly strengthening its research ecosystem. During this AY, sponsored projects worth approximately ₹50 lakh from DST, SERB, and UGC-CRS, complemented by internal funding, have enhanced research infrastructure. International collaborations with the M. N. Mikheev Institute of Metal Physics, Russia, and SUNY Buffalo State, USA, further reinforce the department's growing impact in materials science and radiation physics worldwide.



Beyond The Classroom: *The Fests*

- Aman, R. Vishal, Pranav

Shruthi: Where Every Corner Of Campus Comes To Life

Ask any student in our college which event they look forward to the most. The most probable answer would be Shruthi, our cultural fest. Why, you may ask? Well, this is when you can make memories that last for a lifetime. How? By experiencing thrilling rides at breakneck speeds, getting a polaroid picture captured, or even solving Blue's Clues with your friends. At its heart, Shruthi is the celebration of expression and culture. It is organised by student-led clubs, be it dance, music, literature, or photography. Students who can't find any platform to express themselves and own the stage during these three days are cheered on by their peers. Apart from the performances held throughout the three days of the fest, Shruthi essentially takes the college campus by storm! The walkways are packed with food stalls filling the air with an overwhelming aroma ranging from street food to mouthwatering traditional delicacies. To liven things up even more, Chaitanya Samskruthi, along with a multitude of other clubs, set up a carnival of their own on the ground. Walking around campus during these three days does not feel like the college you've always known; it feels like a miniature town filled with music, lights, and cheer. The energy levels during the fest only increase as the event progresses and finally lead to a grand concert on the third and final day. The grand finale of Shruthi 2026 was headlined by none other than Geetha Madhuri, an artist best known for her melodious and soulful voice in the world of Telugu cinema.

Her performance had the entire campus crooning along, and it seemed like a night nobody on campus would forget in a hurry. To add to this extravaganza, the Deccan Project band, who took the stage right after Geetha Madhuri, put up an absolutely electrifying performance that kept the students grooving for what felt like eternity until the lights were finally dimmed and Shruthi came to an end.



Sudhee: Where Curiosity Comes Alive

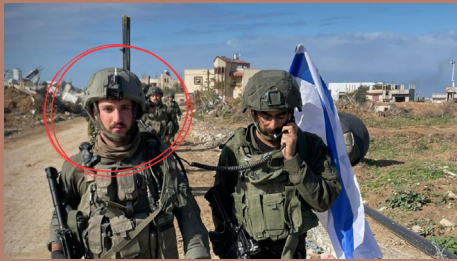
Every engineer is driven by curiosity. At Cbit, this curiosity finds its stage in SUDHEE, our annual technical fest held across two unforgettable days. With this year's theme being 'SWADE-SIGN', it emphasises indigenous development as well as innovation in our country. SUDHEE acts as a break from the constant loop of lectures, tests, and labs as the college becomes a fusion of carnival and technology. What can you expect? Well, you can witness robots battling it out in the arena, race cars engineered with precision, and the constant clatter of the keyboard during coding competitions. From the sound of answers echoing throughout the halls, the valuable conversations filling the air, and the large queue for the various stalls. The college is well and truly alive with engineering brilliance during this fest. If these competitions don't capture your interest, then don't worry – we've got you covered. Each branch hosts its own flagship events, which promise different things whilst also exceeding everyone's expectations. Among the flagship events are Civilizations, Neozion, Chempark and many more, each offering an engaging and exhilarating experience. As part of these events, there are various technical seminars, guest lectures and workshops which shape your perspective and give you an insightful experience. SUDHEE can't be restricted to just a technical fest because it's much more. It is the amalgamation of knowledge and innovation, reflecting the principles and ideals of this college. It encourages you to rediscover the joy of creating and helps you reconnect with your inner child once more as it awakens a level of curiosity you never knew you had. It can't be described by just words, as it is something so beautiful that it has to be experienced. At the end of the fest, as the fireworks light up the night sky and you stand surrounded by your friends, you get a sense of belonging as everything comes full circle.





Beyond The Hummus Trail: Where Tourism, Geopolitics and Accountability intersect

- Vulli Sai Vaibhav, Editor



India has long been one of the most preferred tourist destinations by international visitors, but concerns about alleged illegal activities associated with some visitors in recent years have drawn attention to the so-called hummus trail, a popular travel circuit among young Israeli tourists to travel across various destinations in India and other countries after completing their compulsory military service. According to studies published in 2020, around 80,000 Israelis visit India annually, while reports have highlighted instances of a few individuals engaging

in drug peddling and conducting rave parties along the trail. Israel is currently facing proceedings in the genocide case brought by South Africa at the International Court of Justice (ICJ) over the devastating humanitarian toll of war on Palestinians in the Gaza Strip since the October 7, 2023, Hamas attack. Against this backdrop, the travel of Israelis to India after their military service has come under increased scrutiny. Concerns strengthened recently after the Hind Rajab Foundation (HRF), which is a Palestinian rights organisation based in Brussels, filed a complaint with the Union Ministry of Home Affairs, the Bureau of Immigration and the police to arrest Eitan Gilboa, an Israeli soldier who was found to be vacationing in Himachal Pradesh, traced from the trail. HRF alleged that Gilboa posted acts of killing people and destroying property in Gaza, which is clearly evident that these violate the international humanitarian laws and are considered war

crimes. India doesn't have a standalone law specifically dealing with war crimes, but the Geneva Conventions Act, enacted in 1960, provides a legal framework for implementing the arrest of any person who committed war crimes irrespective of his nationality. Under the Geneva Conventions Act, HRF wanted India to act on Gilboa, but by the time Indian authorities fully processed the paperwork, Gilboa fled India, escaping this arrest. The hummus trail is a tourism travel network, but the changing geopolitical context has raised questions about what happens when tourism intersects with alleged international crimes and how tourism connects to a network of anti-social activities, which also raises broader questions about how deepening India-Israel tourism ties intersect with India's stated commitments to international humanitarian law, particularly amid the ongoing genocide case at the ICJ.

From Temple of Faith to Scandal: The Questions all around the Ram Mandir Trust

- Rachabathula Vishal Sai, Journalist

The investigation of the discrepancies came to light when the ex-chief minister of Uttar Pradesh state, Akhilesh Yadav, posted on his Twitter handle about the issue and called out both the temple trust and the state government for their silence in this regard. With concerns growing, the Yogi Adityanath government announced the formation of an SIT (special investigation team). The SIT comprises Vijay Vishwas Pant, IAS, Divisional Commissioner, Lucknow; Kiran S, IPS, Inspector General of Police; and Neel Ratan, Special Secretary, Finance Department. Initial investigation revealed that the scam could exceed Rs. 200 crores. The officers have seized about 2 crores in cash, a luxury car, and three iPhones. The team is still investigating this issue and is expecting to reveal more in this scam. The ongoing investigation is reportedly heavily focusing on the deletion of seven to eight months of temple CCTV footage, which destroyed critical electronic tracking of the cash counting tables. The BJP government has cleared hurdles for temple construction and taken it as a prestigious project. BJP lost the Faizabad constituency where the construction of Ram Mandir has taken place. With this new scam being discovered and the Uttar Pradesh elections coming up next year, this may have a severe effect on the BJP's chances of forming the government again. Many devotees who donated money for the temple construction and development are questioning



the government on the negligence of temple funds. If this government truly sees itself as the protector of faith, how could it allow such carelessness around the Ram Mandir? This isn't just another project; it's the most sacred and emotionally significant temple for Hindus, built at the very birthplace of Lord Ram. For most people in this country, this temple construction does not only represent religious pride, but also national pride, because the temple case against Babri Masjid went on for decades and was finally won, which, for a few people, restored faith in the judiciary. That is why this scam feels like a betrayal of the people and God by the government.



Across the Border: Effects of the Bangladesh Political Crisis on West Bengal

- Viraja Malaka, Journalist

The collapse of Sheikh Hasina's government in August 2024 sent shockwaves far beyond Dhaka. What began as a student-led protest in Bangladesh quickly transformed into a major political concern in West Bengal, India. Growing concerns about border security and illegal immigration rapidly spread among the citizens of Bengal. People feared that trouble across the border could lead to safety problems, border violence, or a sudden rush of people trying to enter India. BJP was able to build strong support and trust among these important groups of voters ahead of elections. They aggressively framed the Bangladesh PM's fall as proof that border states require strict surveillance and border management. Also blamed TMC for leniency toward illegal cross-border movement. By actively standing up for these concerned citizens and promising them legal protection through the CAA, BJP was able to build strong support and trust among these important groups of voters ahead of elections. TMC's first

line of defence was to bring clarity to the citizens about how the central government is responsible for guarding the international borders. This came as a strong opposition to BJP's claims about TMC, suggesting that if illegal crossing or weak border security was the issue, the blame lies with the central forces guarding the border, not the state police. TMC made an effort to maintain peace among the citizens by ensuring they used their linguistic and cultural identity. They urged citizens not to let external events create mistrust between local Hindu and Muslim groups. TMC put up a strong fight; however, BJP was able to consolidate its voter base and win in the 2026 state assembly elections. The moral issue that has to be looked into here is that it is easy for political groups to use people's fears to gain votes. But relying on fear damages trust between communities that have been living together peacefully. Helping people with care and dignity is always more important than using a crisis for political gain.



Hormuz: The Global Chokepoint That Shook the World

- Arepalli Shouri Riddhima Prasad, Sub-Editor

On 28th of February 2026, the US and Israel struck against Iran, targeting its nuclear facilities and missile infrastructure and killing senior members of its leadership, including its supreme leader, Ali Khamenei. However, Iran's retaliation wasn't with a missile strike; it was geographical. Within hours, the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC) declared the Strait of Hormuz closed to vessels it deemed "malevolent". At its narrowest point, the Strait is just 33km wide, yet it carries over a fifth of the world's crude oil supplies along with a significant share of natural gas exports. As traffic through the Strait declined sharply, the global energy market reacted almost instantaneously and within days, Brent crude prices climbed above \$100 per barrel, reflecting fears of prolonged supply disruptions. The consequences extended beyond rising fuel prices. Several commercial ships were damaged. Insurers responded by increasing war-risk premiums, making every journey through the Gulf substantially more expensive. In response to attacks on vessels, the United States imposed tougher restrictions on Iranian

ports and introduced a dual embargo. This was to discourage attacks and avoid direct military confrontation. Although a brief ceasefire and diplomatic negotiations followed, stability remained elusive. Shipping repeatedly resumed only to be disrupted again as diplomatic efforts faltered. Meanwhile, Yemen's Houthi movement expanded its attacks in the Red Sea, threatening the route; many shipping companies had chosen to avoid Hormuz. China, however, avoided military involvement while continuing to push relentlessly to restore free trade in the region, illustrating how the potential risk of energy security can lead to overcoming even the most bitter political opposition. For India, the crisis hit particularly hard. More than 40% of India's crude oil imports originate in Gulf nations whose exports pass through Hormuz. Going by the laws of economics, as oil prices naturally climbed, the effects spread across the economy, from transportation to everyday essentials, aviation fuel and industrial freight, placing additional pressure on households and businesses, illustrating how a conflict between warring nations

could quietly ripple into household budgets of a country thousands of kilometres away. This crisis proved that in modern geopolitics, power is no longer measured only by armies or missiles, but also by the ability to control the vulnerabilities of global trade. A narrow stretch of water, a handful of mines, and the threat of disruption were enough to send governments scrambling, markets reeling and billions paying the price. Geography has once again proved to be one of the most formidable weapons in international politics.





Everyone Else Seems Happier—Or Do They?

- M Neha Reddy, Editor

Have you ever opened Instagram or Facebook for “just five minutes” and ended up wondering why everyone else seems to be living a more exciting life? From friends travelling to exotic destinations to classmates celebrating achievements, social media often creates the impression that everyone is having a better time than we are. This feeling is known as the Fear of Missing Out, or FOMO, and it has become a common part of life in the digital age. The problem is that social media rarely shows us the complete picture. People usually post their happiest moments; vacations, parties, promotions, or special occasions, while leaving out the ordinary or difficult parts of everyday life. When we compare our daily routines with someone else’s reels, it’s easy to feel as though we’re missing out, even when we’re not. FOMO doesn’t just affect our emotions, it also ends up influencing the choices we make. Many people constantly check their phones, respond to notifications immediately, or

say “yes” to events simply because they don’t want to feel left out. Others spend hours scrolling through social media instead of focusing on work, studies, or spending quality time with their loved ones. Ironically, the more we try to stay connected online, the more disconnected we can become from the present moment. Studies have shown that excessive social media use can contribute to anxiety, stress, and lower self-esteem, especially among teenagers and young adults. Feeling the need to keep up with everyone else can be emotionally exhausting and make it difficult to appreciate our own achievements and experiences. Fortunately, overcoming FOMO is possible. Setting healthy limits on screen time, turning off unnecessary notifications, and taking occasional breaks from social media can make a significant difference. More importantly, focusing on personal goals, practising gratitude, and spending time with family and friends in the real world can help us feel happier and more fulfilled. Social media is a wonderful tool for staying informed and connected, but it should not define our happiness. At the end of the day, the moments that matter most are not always the ones shared online, they are the cherished ones we genuinely experience. By learning to enjoy our own journey instead of constantly comparing it with others, we can replace FOMO with contentment and live a more balanced digital life.



The Outsourcing of Memory

- Snehittha Devara, Journalist

If you lost your phone today, how much of your memory would vanish with it? Probably far more than you expect. We, as humans, are heavily dependent on technology to remember things for us. We now no longer remember birthdays, phone numbers, passwords, or even routes. One convenience at a time, we have largely outsourced much of our memory. The human brain is fundamentally wired to conserve cognitive effort. It often tends to take the path with the least resistance. While the brain is only about two percent of the body’s weight, it uses almost twenty percent of what our body uses when we are at rest. Every thought, decision, or memory retrieval has a biological cost. Hence, the brain has evolved to like shortcuts. If the brain notices that some information is readily accessible, it prefers not to remember it. Psychologists call it ‘cognitive offloading’. It means using external tools to reduce the burden on memory. This makes our brain more efficient. By outsourcing routine information, it frees cognitive resources for possibly more important tasks like problem solving and creativity. Looking at it from an evolutionary standpoint, it is in fact quite logical. However, every adaptation has its own limits. Cognitive offloading can increase our efficiency, but overreliance

on external memory may come at the cost of our own. This convenience might significantly weaken human memory formation. If the brain anticipates that information will be available on a smartphone or search engine, it’s less likely to expend the cognitive effort required to remember it. It tends to remember where it can be found rather than the information itself. This is called ‘Digital Amnesia’ or ‘The Google Effect’. It reduces opportunities for active recall, which strengthens long-term memory. Moreover, the implications extend beyond simple forgetfulness. Another possible downside is the reduced ability to learn deeply. Understanding depends on connecting new information to existing knowledge. If we constantly look up things instead of internalising them, learning may remain superficial. The same holds for critical thinking. Analysis becomes inefficient when every supporting fact must first be retrieved externally. The problem is not memory outsourcing itself, since humans have always relied on external tools to extend memory. The problem begins when convenience replaces thinking. Now that the technology keeps getting better, the question isn’t whether to offload. It’s how much of our memory are we willing to hand over before there’s nothing left to think with.



THE LOST ART OF WAITING

-Sanvith Murari, Sub-Editor

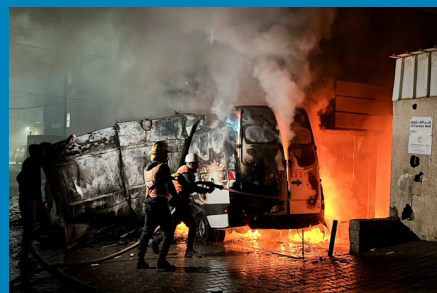


I found myself with a crossword book the other night. As I was whiling away a rare empty time by racking my brain over the downs and across, a question popped into my head. Does anyone ever do puzzles anymore? The answer was unfortunately clear. What do small interstices of crossword-solving do to us unannounced? These activities require stillness. They require us to pause. They ask us to... Wait. These moments leave us idle. With only our friend (and foe), the mind to pass time with. Ironical as it may be, it was this very stillness that caused me to write this at all. Ideally, it has the potential to make the inner voice louder. Instead, we misunderstand it to be boredom- one feeling that humanity collectively shares animosity towards, and has done a commendable job of fighting all its forms every time it wanted to make its presence felt. And in doing so, we elude a bunch of values that we could’ve gained effortlessly. Today, we take a “detox trip” for what was once achieved by, well, waiting. Sitting at a bus window, staring into the horizon should have been an “empty time”. It should lead to imagination, perhaps. The inaction should have allowed the other-

wise jumping mind to pause. To question and search for a solution from within. Instead, a “5 reasons why rice is extremely harmful” reel is keeping us occupied. Even when a deeper question arrives as an unusual visitor into the mind, we would rather help build Gemini’s database. It has compelled us to listen to a deep-voiced man revealing to us that after inhaling, we must exhale, just to listen to ourselves. It is not to say that boredom is loveable. It is, however, a door. One to innovation, introspection, and more importantly, patience. The villains of this story are neither Instagram nor our search for constant action, though they play their part. Rather, it’s our intolerance for quiet. The rush and drive to make every minute productive has led us to new heights, sure. But in that pursuit, we have lost something. Something that did not ask for a heart-aching fee to open up. Something that instilled values so effortlessly, that we have developed whole mechanisms to gain them back. We have, well and truly, lost the art of waiting. So the next time you stare into nothing, just keep staring. You may not discover gravity in doing so, but you may well end up with a much better idea of who you are.

Death of the Press Armour

-Sameeha Yasmin, Journalist



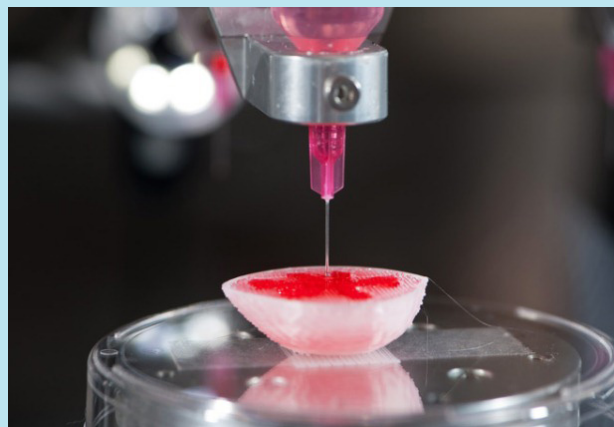
On May 11, 2022, veteran journalist Shireen Abu Akleh was fatally shot in the head while reporting in the West Bank. Was there a rifle concealed under her body armor? Was she carrying explosives? Did she, as an unarmed reporter, pose an active military threat? Absolutely not. Yet, the bullet found its mark. Her death highlighted a terrifying shift on the modern battlefield. The royal blue Kevlar vest with five bold letters ‘PRESS’ once provided a measure of security. Now, it makes them easier to target. Frontline journalists venture into dangerous conflict-hit zones with the sole purpose to uncover the truth. Despite facing wars, humanitarian crises and civic upheavals, they relentlessly work to expose injustice and ensure everyone remains informed. So what has gone wrong in today’s world? For decades, their blue vests were backed by the Article 79 of Additional Protocol I of the Geneva Conventions, which explicitly considers journalists in conflict regions

as protected civilians. In the modern age, they are viewed less as observers of the truth and more as threats to the narrative, because neutrality is now feared. Journalist fatalities reached a historic high in 2025, with 129 media workers targeted in strikes. The tactic of mislabelling journalists as terrorists without providing concrete evidence is one increasingly adopted by both authoritarian regimes and supposedly democratic countries alike. As political unrest and media censorship surge across the world, it directly threatens the safety of journalism. Conditions will only get more dire for the press when those who pull the trigger are not held accountable. When the armour fails and the reporters are silenced, the world is left in the dark. The right way to tackle this is to end legal impunity. Governments must promptly investigate threats, prosecute attackers and hold criminals accountable. Countries that try to bury evidence of killings, shift blame and avoid accountability extinguish the possibility of justice. The need of the hour is to publicly condemn the killing of journalists and serve justice to them and their families. Furthermore, it calls for world peace now more than ever. Harming even neutral observers in a battlefield is not far from a dystopia. A journalist’s selflessness and determination to bring the truth into the light needs to be celebrated, not forced into the crosshairs.



One Small Print for Tissue Engineering, One Giant Leap for Science

- M Neha Reddy, Editor



The biological aspect of science seems to be no longer limited to Earth; it has travelled all the way to space, all the way to the microgravity environments. This operation began when researchers managed to cultivate liver and kidney tissues aboard the International Space Station (ISS) by using technologies that are currently undergoing

tests to upscale the manufacturing operations. Previously, other regenerative experiments have also been conducted in space, one of which includes the successful assembly of cartilage cells using a magnetic field. This mission was carried out by using a machine called the “Bioprinter Organ.Aut” by Russian cosmonaut Oleg Kononenko in 2018. But unlike prior efforts, this year’s team leading the operation prioritized diversity in their endeavors. Although the organ cells were considered the highlight of their accomplishment, other crucial biological materials were also manufactured, notably 28 specific implants intended for the repair of damaged nerves. The tissues were produced using an advanced 3D bioprinter, which works similarly to conventional 3D printers but uses living cells instead of plastic or metal. Scientists first mixed living human cells with a biocompatible hydrogel, creating a material known as bioink, which provides structural support and nutrients for the cells during and after printing. The bioprinter deposited the ink layer by layer according to a digital design. On Earth, gravity causes cells in a bioprinted structure to settle unevenly, making it difficult to create tissues that

closely resemble natural organs. In contrast, the microgravity conditions aboard the ISS allow control over the location of the cells, enabling scientists to produce more organized and structurally accurate tissues. Researchers believe this unique environment could overcome one of the major challenges in tissue engineering and improve the quality of laboratory-grown tissues. Although the printed tissues are not yet fully functional organs, they represent an important milestone toward the future production of transplantable tissues and organ patches. The samples have been returned to Earth for detailed analysis to evaluate their structure, viability, and potential applications. This breakthrough demonstrates the immense capability of space-based biomanufacturing and biomedical research. Scientists can use these tissues to study diseases more accurately, test new drugs, and better understand how human cells behave under weak gravity conditions. While the routine production of transplantable organs in space remains years away, this achievement represents a significant step towards a future where space plays a vital role in improving human health on Earth and beyond.

Dystopian Technology or Human Paranoia as Usual?

-Bhavya Veeramreddy, Sub-Editor

Imagine you’re talking to someone wearing what you think are an ordinary pair of glasses. While you’re talking, their glasses are capturing your face, remembering your name, maybe even pulling up your LinkedIn profile. And the worst part is you don’t even realise it’s happening. Sounds like something straight out of a dystopian novel, doesn’t it? AI glasses could be the dawn of a new era of accessibility technology. Live transcription, real-time translation, and scene description with embedded augmented reality, these glasses feel like technology borrowed from the future. A tourist could walk around in a new city with all the signs being translated instantly. Someone with a visual impairment could ask their glasses to describe their surroundings, while someone who is hard of hearing can use the live transcriptions and instant translations. For all of them, these glasses aren’t “new technology”, they are a whole new way of experiencing the world. But what are they truly costing us? The freedom of roaming in public without the fear of being recorded? Our facial data being sold to companies without our consent? Our daily rou-

tines possibly being constantly recorded? Who is handling our information and how do we know they’re respecting our privacy? Meta AI’s handling of user data has already raised serious concerns. Workers in Kenya were tasked with reviewing graphic videos that were submitted using Meta’s systems. Two users even sued Meta over not being informed adequately about their data usage policy. When asked if they thought the users knew, one of the Kenyan workers reportedly said, “They don’t know, because if



they knew, they wouldn’t be recording.” Humans have a well-documented history of paranoia over emerging technologies. Technophobia has been around since the Industrial Revolution. Whether it was about the railway system, telephones or even smartphones, panic and paranoia were widespread. Now that the once-feared technology is a part of our day to day lives, we find the paranoia mostly exaggerated. But what about the paranoia surrounding the AI glasses right now? Are we repeating the same patterns of irrational fear or have AI glasses crossed a line that previous technologies didn’t? What feels damning for us feels like liberation for others. So who gets to call the shots? The solution to this issue is not to reject AI glasses entirely, but to encourage improved privacy rules and data usage policies. The tiny dim light that indicates whether you’re being recorded? Not enough. With more ethical policies in place, we have an opportunity to make AI glasses the next big thing. Perhaps the question isn’t whether AI glasses are dangerous but whether we’re prepared to use them responsibly.

Why Do We Procrastinate? The Neuroscience Behind It

-Hasini Anne, Journalist

We’ve all experienced the cycle of procrastination at some point: an assignment is due tomorrow, yet somehow we find ourselves scrolling through reels until it’s late, convincing ourselves we’ll just start tomorrow. Many people mistake procrastination for laziness; however, from a psychological perspective, laziness is marked by no energy and general apathy. In contrast, procrastinators distract themselves with less important tasks. In fact, many people procrastinate because they care too much, they’re afraid their work won’t live up to their standards. But why do we keep procrastinating even when we know it’s bad for us? When you realize you need to get a task done, your brain responds as it would to any incoming threat: the amygdala, a part of the brain involved in emotional processing and threat identification, triggers your body’s stress response. This can overpower the impulses from your prefrontal cortex, which typically helps you think long-term and regulate your emotions. Although it may seem extreme, we’re most likely to procrastinate tasks that invoke negative feelings, such as dread and incompetence. The internal conflict between the prefrontal cortex and the limbic system is the heart of procrastination. So when you realise you have an assignment due in a week, two things can happen. The prefrontal cortex says, “an hour a day will be fine.” whereas your



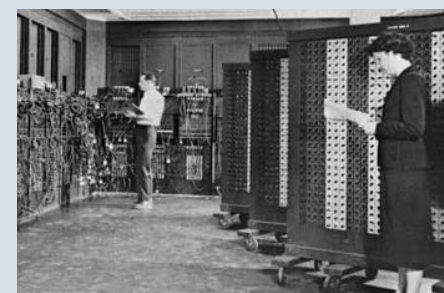
emotional part says, “if I fail, this will ruin everything” and sends a signal to avoid the work. The prefrontal cortex tries to reassure you, but that signal is largely outmatched, especially when the task is both emotionally threatening and genuinely hard. That’s why willpower alone rarely works. Telling yourself to “start” makes the prefrontal cortex shout louder than the amygdala, but the amygdala isn’t built to listen. It’s built to protect first and reason later. Understanding this doesn’t make the deadline disappear, but it reframes the problem: procrastination isn’t a discipline failure; it’s a mismatch between a threat system built for physical danger and a to-do list that isn’t actually dangerous. So instead of fighting the feeling with more pressure, try breaking the task down until it no longer feels overwhelming. Or ask yourself what fear lies beneath the avoidance: fear of failure, fear of falling short of your own standards, or simply not knowing where to start. Next time you’re scrolling instead of starting, ask yourself not, “Why am I so lazy?” but “What about this task feels threatening right now?” The answer won’t erase the deadline, but it might help you take the first step towards it.

Why We Trust AI (Even when it’s wrong)

-Juluri Nithyasri, Journalist

Artificial Intelligence(AI) has become something we turn to first at every point in our life. Encounter a question—ask ChatGPT, it’ll give us an answer in less than a minute”. Trust and dependency on AI has increased so much that a few of us take advice from it for everything, starting from asking typical questions to pouring out their emotions, making it a personal ‘therapist’. Why has AI gained our trust so easily, even when everyone is aware that it is “artificial”? Why are we comfortable taking advice from a machine that doesn’t feel or think as we do? The answer to the above questions would be ‘automation bias’-Automation bias describes our tendency to accept and favor answers from automated decision-making systems, such as ChatGPT, even when we encounter contradictory information. Automated tools have become something we use on a daily basis. Opening Google maps for directions if we are going outside, inquiring about the weather in Google rather than stepping out and asking ChatGPT to help answer questions are few of the many things we do. Anytime we unquestioningly trust and follow the recommendations or decisions of automated tools, we may fall victim to automation bias. Automation bias typically appears in two patterns: Commission errors (what the system says even if it’s wrong) and Omission errors (not doing what you would have done without automation). In 1999,

researchers Mica R. Mosier and Linda J. Skitka coined the term automation bias after flight simulation studies showed that pilots performed worse when relying on the system’s recommendations rather than their own expertise. Real-world incidents reinforce this finding: In 2012, tourists in Australia drove into the Pacific Ocean after following GPS directions, while Knight Capital lost nearly \$440 million in under an hour due to a faulty trading algorithm. These cases highlight the risks of placing unquestioning trust in automated systems. In a world where AI is used everywhere, ‘why do we trust AI?’ AI is trusted widely because it is fast, usually reliable and always available. Just because it is trained for various situations does not automatically make it superior or correct. As AI becomes increasingly integrated into our lives, our greatest responsibility is to remain curious, skeptical, aware and willing to think for ourselves. The future isn’t about humans versus AI, it’s about humans using AI wisely. Trust AI as an assistant, not as your unquestioned authority.



“She” is the Hero

- Arnav Katta, Editor



When you talk about movies led by women with no visible male leads, we probably reminisce about movies like ‘Kahani’, which starred Vidya Balan, who played a pregnant woman trying to find her husband’s killer, and ‘Arundhati’, starring Anushka Shetty, where her character of Jeamma, the Queen of Gadwal in the movie, is still synonymous among the people with how a strong female character should be portrayed on the silver screen. Since then, there have rarely been movies with only female leads which have been popular among the audiences. Which brings us to our present situation, where we are witnessing a significant resurgence of female-led films that proceed without a traditional male lead, centering the narrative entirely on the female protagonist’s journey. Some examples of this trend are Samantha’s “Maa Inti Bangaram,” an action entertainer where the female lead is a resilient and multi-dimensional character, possessing a quiet inner strength that manifests throughout her journey. Her character is not defined by external validation but rather by her inner conflict of how her husband and his estranged family might react to her big dark secret. This portrayal marks a departure from traditional stereotypical roles for women, offering a grounded and compelling look at female leads within the action genre. Huma Qureshi’s role in ‘Baby do die do’ is another great example of this shift. Her character is a mute assassin, a unique pov that adds a distinct layer of intensity to her performance while steering clear of typical lead character tropes. This performance moves away from tired clichés and puts the woman’s perspective right at the center of the film. But the female action genre is not always a smooth sailing boat. There have been hit and misses with movies like Alpha, starring Alia Bhatt and Sharvari, Dhakaad, starring Kangana Ranaut, among others, which have been let down by their flimsy and weak plot lines or bad writing of the female lead characters. This is definitely a welcome change in the Indian movie industry, which still follows the cliched scripts of the last century, where a movie without male leads was unimaginable and women were portrayed as damsels in distress who are always in need of saving or being objectified by male leads for romantic purposes. Moving away from these stereotypes might lead the script writers and directors to create stronger and more emotionally layered female characters, which would add more substance and intrigue to their movies.

Worse Than Murderers: Why do Male-Dominated Fanbases Hate the “Voice of Reason”?

- K. S. V. Sai Vaishnavi, Journalist

In modern TV shows, male anti-heroes commit unimaginable crimes, yet their audience supplies them with their unconditional devotion. Walter White cooks meth and poisons children, and Dexter Morgan dismembers bodies. We root for them anyway. However, the women standing in their way, the characters trying to enforce ethics and protect their families, are vilified. Why do male-dominated fanbases reserve their most bitter hatred not for the murderers, but for the “voices of reason”? The issue boils down to mainly two things: protagonist bias and misogyny. Protagonist bias is the tendency to forgive or justify the actions of the protagonist because the story is told from the point of view of the protagonist. When the show has a male anti-hero character like Walter White, the audience empathizes with him and whatever stands in the way of the main character’s goal is seen as an intolerable interruption. When Skyler White learns of her husband’s secret drug empire in Breaking Bad, she is horrified and tries to protect her family, yet fans label her “annoying” and “unsupportive” of her husband. In Dexter, Debra Morgan discovers her brother’s secret; she struggles with doing the right thing and protecting her brother, but fans dismiss her whole character as a foul-mouthed, emotionally unstable sister. There is a clear double standard: A male character can be morally gray or even outright evil and gets praised as “complex,” but a female character who shows human imperfection, hesitation, or emotional distress is branded annoying and insufferable. When female characters try to demand accountability from the protagonist, they are villainized for daring to interfere and question the main character. These characters are not saints; they are flawed and morally gray human beings surviving impossible situations, yet their attitudes are treated as unforgivable character defects. This double standard shows us how quickly we forgive horrendous crimes when committed by men yet refuse to tolerate women who dare to speak against them. Even when you’re surrounded by men who murder, corrupt, and lie, there is no greater crime than being a flawed woman. Until fan bases understand their bias and think critically, the most dangerous villain on screen will always be a woman telling a man “no.”



Life imitates all art

-P.Teertha, Journalist

“Life imitates art far more than art imitates life” -this quote by Oscar Wilde has been talked about since the late 1800s, some saying it’s true and some saying only the latter is true. While this quote is normally used for positive experiences in life, does it apply to all art? The Handmaid’s Tale is set in a totalitarian, patriarchal regime where women are seen only as incubators with no bodily autonomy. This story draws parallels with the case of Adriana Smith, who was kept on life support for the sole reason of delivering the child she was carrying, despite being declared brain dead. This inhumane decision completely disregarded her and her family’s wishes, stripping her of her rights and dignity over her own body, just like the women in Gilead. Another example of such resemblances is the hit Netflix series, Black Mirror. Each of the 33 episodes of Black Mirror, has a unique storyline. The series is set in the (maybe not so far) future where technology is so advanced that its availability to the public seems like a dangerous and bad idea. However, the humanoid robots, mind- controlling

technology, and other invasive tech used in the series to, in a way, torture people don’t seem too far off from invention in the real world. Powerful generative AI services like Grok, nano banana pro, and ChatGPT are already accessible to the public. This access means that anyone can alter people’s pictures and videos without their consent. After Grok’s image generation tool was heavily misused by netizens to create sexual content of women and children without their consent, the platform has blocked the feature. But at what cost? Could these events have been prevented if we saw dystopian books and series as warnings of what could happen and not just as entertainment or art?

Pick Your Horror: Queer Love Or Supernatural Entities

-Sravani Ambati, Sub-Editor

The Australian coming-of-age supernatural horror film “Leviticus”, despite performing better than expected and surpassing \$8.5 million at the box office, is not being released in most countries worldwide. So far, 2026 has been a big year for the horror genre; films like Obsession and Backrooms, with scarier and more gruesome scenes, are being screened in theatres worldwide. Yet even though Leviticus would fit right in, the film is being marked as “different” and more horrific because it has added queer elements. Countries tend to censor queer media because they believe “non-normative” sex relationships are a potential threat to the existing heteronormative, majoritarian culture. The label “non-normative” is a result of deep-rooted homophobia, making us view queer people differently. While this might just be media censorship, to

many it is a step towards self-censorship. The stigma, discrimination and social exclusion create additional stressors for LGBTQIA+ individuals, the heightened stress leads to increased rates of anxiety, depression, and suicidality in young individuals. This leads to people being under constant fear of being a “misfit” and thinking that their life would be much harder if they started being their true self. The film Leviticus will soon be on streaming platforms and everyone will be able to access it. But, in this day and age when we think there is more acceptance towards the LGBTQIA+ community and more people are getting the courage to be themselves, censoring and refusing to release a hit horror film just because it has queer elements is a huge step backwards. The fact that countries are okay with screening people getting stabbed, beaten to

death and possessed but not with two people being themselves and falling in love with each other is regressive. People are just trying to exist, love who they want and be themselves and yet society turns it into something abnormal making them question their existence. Why is queer representation still a topic up for debate, isn’t queer love just love?





SEZ's: The Business Hubs driving Investments, Jobs and Growth

- Cheekati Saatvika, Sub-Editor



A country's economy can be cut open to see its GDP (Gross Domestic Product), trade and jobs – how the people make, sell and buy things. Weaving itself into the process of a nation's blueprint: taxation stands tall as a high-stakes load for any economy. Now, imagine stripping off the taxes almost entirely and shedding all the administrative friction. What remains is this: a highly valuable piece of land with all power sources, drainage systems, fibre-optic internet lines, and high-capacity pipes directly buried. While asphalt roads connect directly to highways, ports or airports conveniently nearby. This is the master architecture for multinational corporations to build businesses from day one. This is a Special Economic Zone. These are an internationally competitive and hassle-free environment for augmentation of export activities. The SEZ Act of 2005 was passed by the government of India to operate and manage these zones. Its motto is to attract FDI (Foreign Direct Investment) and to establish regional manufacturing or service hubs by offering tax exemptions, reduced tariffs, and

flexible labour regulatory frameworks. The government provides land, tax incentives, and legal status to the SEZ, attracting foreign reserves and currencies like USD and EUR into the country, as well as personal income taxes of the newly hired employees. Co-developers offer Grade A office buildings. Big corporations come to these. They are provided with rainwater systems and on-site sewage treatment plants (STP) across campuses. This creates sustainability and a green culture across the area. Financial District's Nanakramguda is the pedestal for IT/ITES special economic zones of Hyderabad. The land was initially acquired by the Andhra Pradesh Industrial Infrastructure Corporation (APIIC) from the Ministry of Commerce in 2006 for establishing finance and IT firms. As the campus scaled into a major business hub, Singapore's sovereign wealth fund, GIC, stepped in to acquire a 50% joint-venture stake in the office complex in 2015. The value was added as Accenture and TCS signed massive office space leases. The main companies in Nanakramguda's SEZ cluster include Amazon, which built its largest owned campus globally, spanning over 9.5 acres and housing more than 15,000 employees. Google impressively owns its second-largest campus here, behind the US. Such SEZs improve employment for thousands of employees and ultimately bring technology home, provide employment, and support the nation's economy.

Service Exports: Why Are They Becoming a Matter of National Interest?

-Vulli Sai Vaibhav, Editor

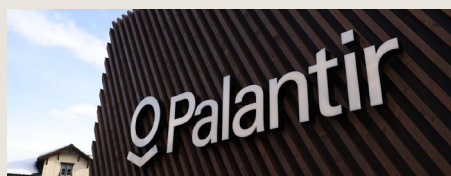
For decades, exports were largely associated with physical goods such as textiles, machinery, farm goods, etc. Advancements in digital technology have significantly transformed international trade. In recent years, it has increasingly expanded to the export of knowledge and expertise in the areas of skill-based sectors. This transformation is fortunate because of the creation of new business opportunities in IT and non-IT service sectors, eliminating the need to travel across countries for work. Services exports of India have grown significantly, becoming a key service exporter globally, sharing its services to more than 100 countries, having a share in global services trade more than doubled from 2% in 2005 to 4.4% in 2024, placing it among the leading service exporters. Recognizing India's strong global position and the growing importance of service exports, Union Budget 2026-27 proposed a range of reforms aimed at supporting and facilitating the growth of the IT and IT-enabled services sector. The major reforms include Boosting of the Cloud service exports through "Data center incentives" which proposes tax holidays until 2047 for foreign companies delivering cloud services to global clients using infrastructure in India, "Safe harbor margin reforms" refer to changes in tax rules that fix a profit margin, raising the transaction limits with a common safe harbor margin of 15.5% while increasing its threshold from 300 crores to 2000 crores and the regime is determined by an automated rule driven process with-



out need of tax officer finally, "Advance Pricing Agreements Reforms" which is a major contract between a taxpayer and a tax authority which pre determines transfer pricing method for future international transactions where the budget proposes to fast-track the process for IT service companies by concluding the agreements within 2 years which can be further extended on taxpayers request. Service exports are increasingly important for diversifying India's trade portfolio and increasing foreign exchange revenues, creating new service export business opportunities across international markets. Because of its qualified and skilled workforce, India is emerging as a major global service provider, and these reforms will further strengthen India and make it a key service provider across the globe, create employment opportunities for the skilled, and lead India toward "Viksit Bharat @2047"

Luck or a 20-year payoff?

- Pranav Erramagari, Journalist



Palantir is a mystery to many. Did this company blow up out of nowhere? Why is it a name often heard when a country's defence is mentioned? More importantly, what do these guys even do? Palantir is a software company that was started in 2003. It does a lot of work with data integration and analytics. They look at a large pile of data that contains a lot of information that is unorganised and find patterns; this is where the company is really good at. For the terror attacks of September 11, 2001, the creation of Palantir was the response by founder Peter Thiel. An integral part of PayPal, Thiel saw use in the company's anti-fraud recognition system, which led to the idea of analysing data to predict terrorist attacks or involvement. In 2004, Thiel and co-founder Alex Karp bankrolled \$30 million for the company and an additional \$2 million in funding by its sole investor, the C.I.A. What followed were multiple contracts with the C.I.A., sustaining the company in its early days. With time, Palantir's services expanded to the US military and went international with the likes of French intelligence, UK defence and many more. By 2018, with several contracts in hand, the company's value rose to \$20 billion. Now we come to the present day, the age of AI and escalating global tensions. In

April 2023, the Artificial Intelligence Platform (AIP, in short) was launched. The company's heavy reliance on governments was cracked with AIP. This product was sought after by numerous US corporations like Amazon, Wendy's, and Walgreens, widening their customer base. Meanwhile, their involvement in Ukraine and Gaza proved to be somewhat of a testing ground to showcase the capability of their tech to different militaries around the world. These engagements could be a reason for some of their current historical deals, which include a 10-billion-dollar deal with the US Army and a \$1 billion contract extension deal with the UK. Palantir is also cited as a benefactor in the US-Iran war, noting its significant 15% stock increase after the first attack. So, we come back to the question. Is Palantir's rise to relevance of this scale just luck? The short answer is no. This company bet on the longevity of data analysis in the ongoing digital age and dependence on information. Countries like the United States, whose participation in military engagements increases day by day, create the need for companies like Palantir to keep up with their demands, which makes them the perfect customers.



Startup Accelerators: Bridging ideation with investment

- Nimmagadda Koushik, Journalist



India's free market economy is emerging as a global startup powerhouse as innovators are converting real-life problems into monetizable business ideas. Startup accelerators act as the institutional pillars that sustain this rampant growth in startups. Their main role is to provide a structured launchpad for early-stage startups through funding as well as customer and other investor credibility by lending their brand names. Shark Tank India is a startup accelerator famous for its television and media coverage along with its populist portrayal of startup pitches. Here, startups directly pitch to well-renowned angel investors, termed as 'Sharks'. Its success is the predominant emphasis laid on B2C startups, directly selling consumer goods solving basic day-to-day issues in an affordable way. This show has over \$39.65 million pledged capital spanning across 5 seasons aired till now. The real impact of this accelerator is also on the startups, often experiencing up to 300% increased website traffic after airing due to this massive viewer base, as well as the public influence of the sharks, also enabling them to scale rapidly onto quick commerce platforms such as Zepto and Blinkit. The most famous investment is

the clothing startup 'Snitch', which received an investment of \$156,500 USD in return for 1.5% equity in the second season. Y Combinator India is a dark horse in startup accelerators, working behind the scenes investing in scalable technology-based startups such as SAAS platforms. These are often B2B companies or AI platforms having a promising future but behind the spotlight. Almost 300 Indian startups were uplifted, including the 4 global unicorns Razorpay, Meesho, Zepto, and Groww. The main source of acquiring these startups to participate in their sessions is by conducting rigorous online application rounds and interviews, which are intended to shortlist the finalists. While Shark Tank provides an instant boost in public visibility, Y Combinator entrusts these startups with organizational credibility, helping them get further investments. They provide startup founders with 12 weeks to develop their prototype, and on the "Demo Day", they are empowered to acquire funding from global investors. Despite operating on the contrasting poles of popularity, Y Combinator and Shark Tank cater to different kinds of platforms under the umbrella of startup acceleration. Shark Tank is the haven for consumer-oriented startups that require elaborate consumer attention, while Y Combinator is the gold standard for scalable as well as futuristic technologies meant for global software markets.



Queens of the Lord's

- Arnav Katta, Editor



In the cricketing world, there are few moments more cherished than lifting the World Cup. One among them would be to win a Test match at the Lord's; to be able to walk through the Long Room, witness the famous slope of the ground, and get your name etched on the honours board would be a dream come true for many aspiring and established cricketers. For women's cricket, however, this hallowed turf represents more than just tradition; it is a symbol of hard-fought recognition. Historically, the gates of Marylebone Cricket Club remained closed to female players for centuries, making every delivery bowled in the maiden women's Test match at the iconic venue a testament to the pioneers who broke those barriers. In the heart of the "Home of Cricket", cricketers are weighed down by the past legends as they build a new legacy for the future. For our Indian Women's Cricket Team, a victory here isn't just a win on the scoreboard; it is a chance to be immortalised in cricketing folklore as the first women's team to win a Test at Lord's. Our Queens of the Pitch have made this dream a reality in their historic Test match against England. The players achieved the enviable

feat of getting their names on the prestigious Lord's honours board with great skill and fortitude. Several standout performances secured this historic win. Smriti Mandhana was in good touch with her bat. Her elegant strokes and patience at the crease in both the innings laid a steady foundation for the team. Complementing this were the crucial contributions from Kranti Goud, who took a five-wicket haul with bowling figures of 5-37 in the first innings, helping stop the mighty English batting prowess. In the process of doing so, she also became the first woman cricketer to get her name on the honours board. The main character of the second part of the Test was definitely Yastika Bhatia, with her amazing score of 115 runs in a very patient and put-together performance, which made a significant impact and solidified India's hold on the game, ensuring the team remained ahead at every turn. This victory at Lord's is proof of the Indian team's extraordinary mental toughness. Coming off a disappointing campaign at the T20 World Cup, the squad demonstrated remarkable strength and character to rise to the occasion.



Is India ready to become a sporting giant?

- Aman Cyril Pudota, Journalist



"In a nation of over 1.4 billion", that's the number journalists quote at every World Cup and Olympic Games. It continues to dominate discussions as they try to dissect the reasons why the tricolour isn't flying high on the world's biggest sporting stages. A lot of this stems from long-standing misconceptions. One such misconception is the belief that sports don't offer viable career opportunities beyond schooling. This is the mindset of many parents in India, and the dreams of many who aspire to a career in sports are squashed as a result of this mindset. This goes hand in hand with the modern curriculum, which doesn't offer any scope in terms of sporting prospects. The belief that only a career in engineering or in the healthcare sector is viable is completely false. In the present day, there is a rise in alternative career paths, and sport is a unique and lucrative career path. Apart

from providing financial incentives to the athletes who win medals in the Olympics, there has to be a major investment in different sports. There is immense talent at the grassroots level, waiting to be discovered. When the investment starts pouring in, the mindset of the people will change, and they will start to view sports as a legitimate career path. Another concern is the lack of sporting opportunities beyond secondary schooling. A major requirement is the complete overhaul of the collegiate sports system by adopting a system which is similar to the NCAA model in the United States. This overhaul will help students who aspire to a career in sports take the next step instead of withering away their talent. If such a system is created, we can nationalize college sports, improve the college sporting culture, take the potential of the athletes to the next level, and open a pathway for millions of athletes to rise. In a positive development, there are a lot of private sports tournaments for secondary schools that are gaining traction. One such tournament is Varsity, which takes place in Hyderabad. We can utilize this model and extend it to Tier-2 and Tier-3 cities as well. Is India ready to become a sporting giant? No, not without a long-term vision that turns these ideas into action. Only then can India hope to see the tricolour flying high across the sporting world.



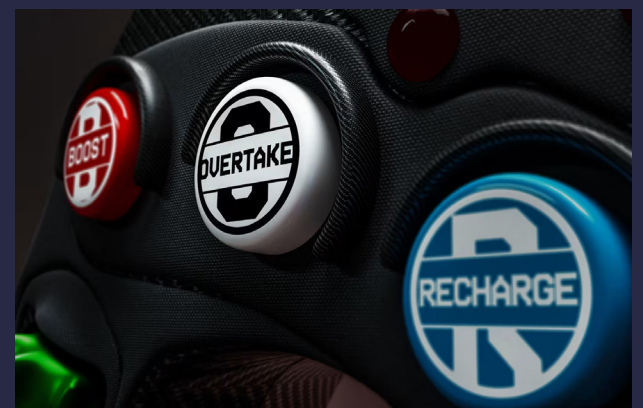
FORMULA 1 2026: BRAINS BEHIND THE PACE

- Shashank Katta, Journalist

F1 has long been considered the ultimate motorsport, where the quest for speed is driven by innovation and engineering excellence. The regulations for 2026 had major technical changes to make the sport sustainable, competitive, and technologically advanced. "F1 is showing its commitment to cleaner and more efficient performance without compromising on the thrill of the race. Imagine a driver exiting the final corner with extra electric energy instead of waiting for DRS; they'll unleash the energy and take a quick dive into turn 1. The biggest change to the power unit in 2026 is the greater use of electric power. F1 cars now take about half their power from an electric source, half from the V6 engine, making the sport more sustainable and adding a new layer to the racing strategy. To make racing and overtaking easier, Formula 1 has made the cars smaller and lighter. The wheelbase has been shortened, the car width and the minimum weight have been lowered. These changes will make cars more agile and make drivers race closer to each other, giving edge-of-the-

seat moments for the audience. The new regulations also introduce Recharge and Boost modes to improve energy management. When you brake or lift off the throttle, the car goes into Recharge Mode to capture electrical energy and store it in the battery for later use. It makes the drivers think more strategically." Drivers can activate Boost Mode, tapping into that stored energy and releasing it at the key moments to make the race that much more competitive. Many fans felt that overtaking had become too easy because drivers relied heavily on DRS, making the race look less competitive. The traditional Drag Reduction System (DRS) has been removed from 2026. F1 cars now use Active Aerodynamics, where the car automatically changes its wings to be faster on straight sections and have better grip around the corners. This will make drivers rely on their skills and strategy to overtake rather than wing features. These innovations are set to redefine how teams design, race, and compete, proving that in Formula 1, strategy is just as important as speed. While fans might debate

the changes that have been brought this season, they will definitely agree that F1 has always been reinventing itself over the decades. If the new regulations deliver closer battles and more exciting moments on track, the 2026 season could be remembered as the start of one of Formula 1's most exciting eras.



Lionel Messi at 39: Defying Time and Defining Greatness

- Ved Kartik, Sub-Editor

Most footballers begin slowing down in their mid-thirties, but Lionel Messi continues to perform at an extraordinary level even at the age of 39. He isn't the same young Messi who can dribble past 3 defenders and score but his football intelligence, vision, passing, and finishing remain among the very best in the world. Messi has perfected his game relying on experience, positioning, world-class playmaking, and decision-making rather than explosive speed. His dedication to fitness, recovery, and professionalism has also helped him compete against players nearly half his age. His international career is the true barometer of this longevity. Playing in six World Cups from 2006 to 2026, that is two decades of greatness that Lionel Messi has proved to the entire world. His stats are incredible at this age. With 21 goals and a record-shattering 12 assists on the biggest stage of all, he is the second-highest goalscorer and has the highest assists in World Cup history. Fans will never forget

the 2026 knockout run, particularly that masterclass hat-trick he scored in Argentina's first match of the World Cup against Algeria, which proved that he could still shoulder the weight of a nation's expectations when it mattered most. Lionel Messi competing with youngsters for the Golden Boot and Golden Ball at his age just shows how



great he is at what he loves doing the most. Eight goals scored and 4 assists provided in the 2026 World Cup, carrying Argentina to the finals at 39 years old, is something that can only be achieved by Lionel Andrés Messi Cucittini. Messi's World Cup journey over the last few years has been a rollercoaster of emotions. After the heartbreak of the 2014 World Cup run, the brilliance of the 2022 run in Qatar where he scored in every knockout game made the entire world consider Messi as the greatest of all time. Reaching another World Cup Final in 2026 at 39 is admirable, proving that Messi still has the same hunger to make his country proud. Messi remains a joy to watch as he turns the pitch into his personal playground, threading impossible passes with pinpoint accuracy. Beyond the record-breaking stats, he leaves behind a timeless legacy. He redefined what was possible, leaving fans everywhere spoiled with greatness.

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